



BLOOD ON THE STREETS

Outlaw life, if only to survive

First in a series.

By Bob Hohler
GLOBE STAFF

Milton DoSouto parked his car along the cemetery road and labored with his cane to walk toward the gravesite of his two slain brothers.

He looked around for signs of danger. He was vigilant wherever he went, but this place, New Calvary Cemetery in Mattapan, had been especially perilous. His enemies came to visit their own dead; he'd been shot at here before. But all was quiet now. He kept moving.

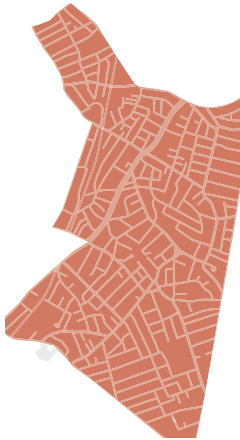
It was 2019. He was 38 years old, trying to make it to 40. He had a child and a stable life a few miles removed from the Dorchester neighborhood where he grew up and where years before he had made himself a feared gang lord at the center of a historic conflagration of violence known as the Cape Verdean war.

The war pitted family against family, tore apart childhood friendships, and sowed fear for more than two decades in the Cape Verdean community in Dorchester where it broke out. The ferocity and pace of the killing baffled city leaders, who seemed powerless to stop it. Gunfire erupted almost daily, on street corners, from car windows, front porches, one backyard to another. Milton and his brother Mike, both victims and leading perpetrators of the violence, ran one of the war's most notorious

DOSOUTOS, Page A12



CRAIG F. WALKER/GLOBE STAFF



Long-running feuds among rivals within the Cape Verdean community claimed more than **65 lives**, nearly all along the streets of the Uphams Corner and Bowdoin-Geneva neighborhoods.

Isaura Mendes greeted Milton DoSouto near the graves of her sons Bobby and Matthew, who were killed amid gang warfare in Boston.

'You can't put the New England Patriots into a blind trust.'

ARCHON FUNG, director, Ash Center for Democratic Governance and Innovation at Harvard Kennedy School

Kraft mayoral bid raises conflict concerns

Candidate says he would recuse himself from all family business

By Emma Platoff and Janelle Nanos
GLOBE STAFF

In late January, just days before Josh Kraft announced his run for mayor of Boston, city officials were readying for a meeting on a topic of great relevance to his family: whether taxpayers would shoulder some of the costs related to the World Cup matches being held next summer at Gillette Stadium, which the Krafts own.

The Jan. 27 meeting was with members of the FIFA World Cup Boston 2026 host committee, which has deep ties to the Krafts: Two of its three board members are executives at family businesses. The committee said it needed \$170 million for such expenses as busing fans to Foxbor-

ough, improving the nearby commuter rail station, and replacing the stadium's turf field with grass, according to draft documents obtained by the Globe.

If organizers cannot raise enough money, whether from government funds or private donors, FIFA could take its games elsewhere, the committee warned in documents presented to city and state officials.

"If this were to occur, there would be significantly negative reputational impacts" for the city, state, and stadium, the document said.

The ongoing discussions about World Cup costs are just one fresh, glaring example of the conflicts of interest that could routinely confront Josh Kraft should he be

elected mayor of Boston. When he launched his campaign, Kraft, a longtime nonprofit executive, asked the city to "set aside any ideas they might have about me based on my last name." But, should he win the city's highest office, the novice politician's ties to his family and its businesses will be hard to ignore.

The Kraft operation includes the New England Patriots and Revolution, real estate, a paper goods empire, and an extensive charitable arm that is deeply entrenched in the city. Robert Kraft and his sons sit on boards and donate to organizations in Boston and beyond, a landscape that legal and ethics experts say would

KRAFT, Page B10

Getting to 'yes' on RFK choice

Public reaction a considerable factor in vote

By Sam Brodey and Tal Kopan
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — On Capitol Hill, the defining sound of Robert F. Kennedy Jr.'s confirmation battle may not have been the angry tenor of arguments during committee hearings or the dramatic flair of floor speeches, but the endless ringing of telephones in the offices of 100 senators.

While many of President Trump's nominees for his Cabinet attracted high levels of interest from the public, few provoked such intense support and opposition as his pick to run the Department of Health and Human Services.

Kennedy's confirmation fight featured an array of outside actors, on both sides, working to channel those strong reactions into pleas to senators in hopes of swaying their votes.

While outside political pressure was a decisive factor in the confirmation of Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth as well, there was a unique dimension to the public's role in Kennedy's process. It was less a proxy war over Trump's power and more a war over

KENNEDY, Page A6

Employees at the EPA's New England regional office described a culture of fear and paralysis amid the massive federal layoffs happening under the Trump administration. **Metro, B1.**

Ireland is producing an entertainment renaissance, and we're here for it. **SundayArts, N1.**



A Red Sox welcome

Alex Bregman took the field at spring training and has already showed the leadership the team is counting on. **c1.**



Slop it now

Sunday: Breezy, rainy. High: 38-43. Low: 20-25.

Monday: Very windy. High: 27-32. Low: 13-18.

Complete report, **C14.** Deaths, **A18-23.**

VOL. 307, NO. 47

Suggested retail price \$6.00



CRAIG F. WALKER/GLOBE STAFF

Hannah Mailey (left), Maggie Theofanides, and Aoi Tamura worked on an experiment at Salve Regina University, which posted strong financial outcomes.

New tool amplifies debate over the cost of higher ed

By Hilary Burns
GLOBE STAFF

With college sticker prices approaching six figures, and students increasingly wary of taking on big loans, one question is increasingly top-of-mind for those immersed in the college search process: Will my hefty investment in a four-year degree pay off?

The answer is, usually — but not always, according to a new return-on-investment tool that's gaining traction among education researchers and public policy makers. Where, and especially what, a student studies can make an enormous difference in whether they graduate with a promising financial future.

The tool, a searchable database developed by economist Preston Cooper of the right-leaning American Enterprise Institute, shows the estimated return on investment, or ROI, for college

COLLEGES, Page A16